MAMDOUH ALENEZI, Ph.D.

AI Strategy & Digital Transformation Executive

National AI Capability · Technology & Responsible AI Governance · Enterprise Architecture · Executive Change Leadership

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

C-suite technology and transformation leader operating at the intersection of national strategy, enterprise architecture, and artificial intelligence. General Manager of SDAIA Academy, the capability-development arm of the Saudi Data & Artificial Intelligence Authority, accountable for the Kingdom's data and AI talent agenda under Vision 2030 and the Human Capability Development Program. Twelve-plus years of progressive executive leadership across a national AI authority, a national technology company, and a research university, repeatedly entering institutions at an inflection point and leaving behind a governed, standards-aligned, KPI-measured operating model. Full Professor of Software Engineering and Prosci® Certified Change Practitioner, trusted to brief ministers, boards, and regional policy bodies.

EXECUTIVE EXPERTISE

- AI Strategy & Roadmaps
- Enterprise Digital Transformation
- Technology & AI Governance
- Responsible AI Frameworks
- Enterprise Architecture
- Transformation Governance & PMO
- Target Operating Model Design
- Organizational Design & Change
- Change Management (Prosci)
- National AI Capability & Talent
- Curriculum & Certification Systems
- KPI Design & Performance Systems
- Quality Systems (ISO, CMMI)
- Accreditation (ABET, AACSB)
- Data Governance & Data Sovereignty
- Scalable Infrastructure & DevOps
- Strategic Partnerships & Alliances
- Ministerial & Board Engagement
- Vision 2030 Program Alignment

EXECUTIVE EXPERIENCE

Saudi Data & Artificial Intelligence Authority (SDAIA)

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

General Manager, SDAIA Academy

03/2026 – Present

Enterprise accountability for strategy, portfolio, quality, partnerships, and performance across the Academy's advanced training, bootcamp, and professional-certification programs; five operating units.

- **National strategy ownership:** Direct the Kingdom's data and AI talent-development agenda, translating Vision 2030, the National Strategy for Data & AI, and Human Capability Development Program targets into a governed, KPI-measured national portfolio of advanced training, bootcamps, and professional certification.
- **Performance architecture redesign:** Following reorganization into five operating units, consolidated duplicated legacy indicators into 12 core KPIs within a two-tier model (8-KPI executive scorecard plus unit-level KPIs), moving institutional measurement from training completion to skills attainment, employment, and professional impact.
- **Portfolio consolidation at national scale:** Led integration of the Information Technology Institute's training portfolio into the Academy (August 2026), owning the transition communication plan and executive engagement to consolidate national technology training under one governed platform.
- **Government decision-maker reach:** Launched an AI Executive Program for senior ministry leadership (October 2026) with sequential rollout across sector ministries, extending the Academy's mandate from practitioners to the leaders who set national AI adoption policy.
- **Capability architecture:** Architected a modular, stackable learning-path catalog spanning Data Scientist and AI Engineer tracks, including expert-level programs in agentic AI systems engineering, enabling accredited progression from foundation to expert.
- **International quality standards:** Established the quality-system foundation for ISO 21001:2025 certification and an instructor evaluation and accreditation framework anchored to ISO 21001 and Kirkpatrick outcome levels.
- **Regional policy leadership:** Chair the Capacity Building & Partnerships team of the Arab Standing Committee on Artificial Intelligence; govern partnerships with universities, research institutions, and industry to co-develop curricula and scale accredited national pathways.

Tahakom (national smart-mobility & public-safety technology company)

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

Director, AI Academy & Acting Director, Technology Governance

08/2024 – 03/2026

Dual executive mandate: enterprise AI capability building and company-wide technology governance, enterprise architecture, and portfolio assurance.

- **Transformation governance:** Redefined the technology governance operating model and elevated enterprise-architecture maturity, aligning the technology investment portfolio with corporate strategy and transformation objectives.
- **Enterprise PMO institutionalization:** Authored and institutionalized an enterprise PMO playbook spanning the full project lifecycle; led governance audits, maturity assessments, and remediation roadmaps to secure value realization across the technology portfolio.
- **Opportunity-to-launch process:** Deployed an end-to-end cross-business-unit process for developing, approving, and launching new business opportunities, replacing ad hoc hand-offs with defined ownership and decision gates.

- **Engineering excellence:** Overhauled policies, processes, and the SDLC with CMMI-aligned quality controls and CI/CD-enabled DevOps, improving release speed, traceability, and software quality across delivery teams.
- **Enterprise AI capability ecosystem:** Built structured training, competency-based certification, and recurring AI town halls in partnership with research-driven companies and leading universities; founded an AI scholarship program sponsoring engineers for graduate study at top-30 global universities, creating a long-term pipeline of advanced AI expertise.

Prince Sultan University — Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

Founding Dean, College of Space & Aviation Sciences — 04/2024 – 08/2024

- **Institution building:** Established one of the Kingdom's first dedicated space and aviation colleges from inception, defining academic vision, governance structure, and an initial portfolio of four bachelor's and three master's programs aligned with national aerospace ambitions.
- **International benchmarking:** Forged partnerships with universities hosting established space and aviation colleges to transfer expertise and align programs with international practice.

Dean, Quality Assurance & Development — 09/2020 – 08/2024

- **Accreditation at scale:** Secured international program accreditation from ABET, AACSB, and HCÉRES and national institutional accreditation from NCAAA/ETEC, alongside ISO certifications, positioning the university among nationally recognized quality leaders.
- **Institutional strategy:** Led the university's fourth strategic plan (seven years, five strategic themes under the DRIVE framework) and implemented a university-wide Quality Management System embedding continuous improvement across academic and administrative units.

Dean, Educational Services — 09/2018 – 08/2020

- **Student-journey governance:** Owned the end-to-end student journey; restructured the Preparatory Year Program into an independent department and tightened governance of placement testing, evaluation, and advising.
- **Evidence-based retention:** Led an analytics-driven study of first-year attrition and introduced targeted policy interventions to raise performance in English and mathematics.

Chief Information & Technology Officer — 01/2015 – 08/2019

- **Digital transformation:** Authored and executed a three-year digital transformation strategy; delivered an institution-wide ERP implementation across finance, accounting, and HR on a scalable, integrated infrastructure.
- **Data-driven leadership:** Built an automated faculty evaluation system across research, teaching, community service, and professional development, giving leadership a quantified basis for performance decisions.

Chair, Department of Computer Science — 09/2015 – 08/2016

- Redesigned the curriculum to IEEE, ACM, and ABET standards, institutionalized structured employer feedback, and recruited and retained high-caliber faculty.

ADVISORY, BOARD & POLICY ENGAGEMENT

- **Chair, Capacity Building & Partnerships Team, Arab Standing Committee on Artificial Intelligence** (2026 – Present): regional capacity-building agenda and monthly policy reporting across Arab member states.
- **Strategic Planning Consultant, CYBEX, Prince Sultan University** (11/2023 – Present): strategy formulation, multi-stakeholder workshops, and vision-to-initiative documentation.
- **Principal Investigator, KACST-funded research** (2017 – 2018): machine-learning-driven dynamic capacity provisioning for cloud networks.
- **University governance:** member of eight university-level committees, including Strategic Planning and ABET Steering.

EDUCATION & EXECUTIVE CREDENTIALS

- **Ph.D., Software Engineering**, North Dakota State University, USA (2014) · **M.S., Software Engineering**, DePaul University, USA (2011) · **B.S., Computer Science**, Prince Sultan University (2010)
- **Prosci® Certified Change Practitioner** (2025) · **Strategy Specialization**, Harvard Business School Online (2024): Strategy Execution, Disruptive Strategy, Sustainable Business Strategy

ACADEMIC STANDING & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

- **Full Professor of Software Engineering**, Prince Sultan University (2022–2024; faculty since 2014). Peer-reviewed research in AI-native and agentic software engineering, AI governance, AI in education, and innovation management informs the frameworks applied in executive practice.
- Designed the B.S. and M.S. in Software Engineering, the M.S. in Cybersecurity Engineering, and a Digital Transformation track; General Chair of three international data science and machine learning conferences (SDMA 2018; CDMA 2020, 2024); program committee member for 13+ international conferences; reviewer for 11 indexed journals, including *ACM Computing Surveys*.